



WILL WARASILA FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

A Lonely Battle in Big Sky Country
A stay-at-home mother is doing what she can to prevent a vast A.I. data center from rising near her property in Montana. Page A12.

China Aims A.I. at Nipping Dissent in the Bud

By JULIAN E. BARNES
NASHVILLE — A Chinese company has been trying to develop artificial intelligence-powered technology that would enable authoritarian governments to not just monitor dissidents but also potentially predict who could become one in the future.
The work, which appears to be in the research stage, is ripped out of dystopian science fiction, offering a glimpse of a world in which an authoritarian state is able to move against its citizens before they begin any public dissent.
The Chinese company, Geedge Networks, sells a commercial ver-

Mining Telecom and Social Data to Sketch Predictive Profiles
sion of the Great Firewall, the surveillance and censorship software that China uses to control online activity. Those tools allow governments to monitor internet traffic and flag when someone tries to get around traditional internet censorship.
But according to leaked company documents, the firm is working on new products that use arti-

ficial intelligence to examine location data and internet use to predict who could do or say something critical of the government, according to researchers at Vanderbilt University.
Such technology, if perfected, would give authoritarian governments a powerful tool to use against perceived enemies.
The idea that an authoritarian government would use artificial intelligence to suppress dissent is troubling enough. But the use of A.I. to predict dissent well before a person has taken action has become a nightmare scenario, according to some involved in the industry.
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VINCENT ALBAN FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Protests at ICE Facility in Newark
Gov. Mikie Sherrill said visiting hours would resume at the Delaney Hall detention center. Page A20.

Trump on His Presidential Library: He’ll Write His Own History

By ELIZABETH WILLIAMSON and MINHO KIM
WASHINGTON — President Trump’s presidential library, planned as a gilded glass tower on a donated chunk of Miami waterfront, is designed to be what Eric Trump, the president’s middle son, calls “a lasting testament to an amazing man.” If the president has his way, it will also serve as a monument to his norm-busting conduct in office.
Mr. Trump had said that the \$1 billion project, the priciest presidential library yet, could include a hotel and retail sales outlets. But more disturbing to historians and government watchdogs is his determination to own and control every document a presidential library would contain. Not since the Watergate era, when President Richard M. Nixon took his fight to

Looking to Shield Some Papers From Public
control the incriminating White House tapes to the Supreme Court, has a president worked so hard to shield documentary evidence of his administration’s inner workings from public view.
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Business Push Nearly Absent For Mamdani

This article is by Dana Rubinstein, Sally Goldenberg, Jeffery C. Mays and Emma Goldberg.
Over the course of his early tenure as mayor, Zohran Mamdani has filled out City Hall’s upper ranks with people he trusts to implement his democratic socialist-inflected agenda in New York City, the nation’s financial capital.
But one arm of city government continues to bedevil him: the Economic Development Corporation, whose mission is to leverage city real estate and tax incentives to attract private capital and drive job growth across the five boroughs.
Five months into the mayor’s tenure, the nonprofit corporation remains officially rudderless, with City Hall officials considering at least 10 candidates for E.D.C. president, including a consumer protection advocate and pro-business types. But the mayor’s team has been unable to coalesce around any of them, illustrating an internal debate over how to direct the organization.
The uncertainty surrounding the E.D.C.’s leadership and direction has fed the notion, widespread among business leaders and moderate Democratic politicians, that Mr. Mamdani is insufficiently attuned to the health of New York City’s economy, and that his inattention potentially comes at his, and the city’s, peril.
It also raises larger and more fundamental questions: What kind of economic policy does the mayor want to embrace? And is
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Voting Decision Unleashes Seismic Shift Across South

Generational Fight as Maps Confuse Many and Put Black Incumbents at Risk

By EMILY COCHRANE and RICK ROJAS
MONTGOMERY, Ala. — It is a confusing moment to be a voter in the South.
Republican leaders across the region have redrawn congressional maps at breakneck speed since the Supreme Court weakened the Voting Rights Act, leading primaries to be postponed, a veteran House member to abandon his re-election bid and new candidates to charge into races ahead of the November midterms.
The outcome could be the most sweeping reconfiguration of the region’s political landscape in at least a generation, pushing what was already a largely red swath of the country more firmly into the Republican column and jeopardizing the political careers of a number of Black Democrats.
In the meantime, the rush to redistrict is stoking a fierce debate over what representation should look like in the South — as well as more pragmatic questions about district boundaries that are shifting, or may soon shift, under voters’ feet.
“They literally have created chaos,” said Mayor Chaz Molder of Columbia, Tenn., a Democrat whose home was drawn out of the Tennessee district where he had spent months running for Congress when Republican state lawmakers adopted a new map in early May. “It’s the voter that loses in this kind of partisan gamesmanship.”
Recent redistricting efforts have not been limited to the South, nor have Republicans been behind all of them. But President Trump pushed the party to adopt the strategy even before the Supreme Court ruling, recognizing the uphill battle that Republicans faced to maintain their slim House majority in the midterms.
Texas began the current redistricting wars last summer at the behest of Mr. Trump, drawing a new map in an effort to flip five House seats to Republicans. Democrats in California responded in kind, and several other states followed last fall. But it was the Supreme Court ruling that set off the frenzy in the South, where the Voting Rights Act had long protected a handful of districts with a majority of Black voters who have largely elected Black Democrats.
About 60 percent of Black Americans live in the South, a share that has grown in recent years in a reversal of the exodus from the region during the Great Migration, according to an analysis by the Brennan Center for Justice, a public policy institute.
At least a third of the population is Black in Georgia, Louisiana and Mississippi, as is about one in four voters in Alabama. But while Republicans fully control almost every Southern state, the region remains racially polarized, as most of the districts with a majority of Black voters lean Democratic and have elected Black representatives.
They include James E. Clyburn of South Carolina and Bennie Thompson of Mississippi, who have both served more than three decades in Congress. Georgia has four Black members of the House. As recently as 2024, rulings tied to the Voting Rights Act paved the way for the creation of new dis-

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DOUG MILLS/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Vice President JD Vance is often needed by President Trump.

Is Vance Heir Apparent in ’28? His Boss Doesn’t Seem Sure.

By KATIE ROGERS and TYLER PAGER
WASHINGTON — In recent conversations with aides and allies, President Trump often interjects with a question about his vice president: Does JD Vance have what it takes to go all the way?
He usually answers his own question: He’s not so sure.
It is not that Mr. Trump is abandoning Mr. Vance. He involves him in major decisions, has given him high-profile opportunities to position himself for 2028 and trusts the 41-year-old vice president to wage partisan warfare on his behalf. In a cabinet meeting last week, Mr. Trump compared Mr. Vance to Eliot Ness, the mob-busting federal agent, for working to ferret out fraud in mostly Democratically controlled states.
Mr. Trump has long conducted running focus groups on his closest aides, and appears to enjoy needling them and keeping them off balance as a way of asserting his dominance. Several people in the president’s inner circle have been subject to his quasi-public questioning of their performance and their future.
But when it comes to Mr. Vance, the stakes are higher. As the default front-runner for the Republic-

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INTERNATIONAL A4-9
Trash Consumes Havana
A fuel blockade on Cuba has aggravated a lack of consistent garbage pickup and produced huge rubbish piles. *PAGE A6*

Billionaire Heads to Argentina
Peter Thiel’s move to the country stems from concerns about the future and shared beliefs with its leader. *PAGE A4*

BUSINESS B1-5
Evading Air Industry Chaos
Delta Air Lines has become the most profitable U.S. carrier by catering to affluent travelers, but it is facing stiffer competition from United. *PAGE B1*

Energy Giant’s Political Clout
NextEra, which wants to buy Dominion Energy, has clashed with consumer groups and journalists. *PAGE B1*

OBITUARIES B6-7
Exiled Ex-Leader of Yemen
Abdu Rabbu Mansour Hadi was the president of the war-torn country from 2012 to 2022. He was 80. *PAGE B6*



NATIONAL A10-17, 20
A Sport in Its Final Stretch
West Virginia is home to the country’s last greyhound races, which may soon be banned nationwide. *PAGE A10*

They’re Demons, Not U.F.O.s
The prospect of extraterrestrial life raises unsettling theological implications for some Christians. *PAGE A11*

SPORTS D1-8
Has End to the Shift Worked?
The change has helped Major League Baseball look a lot more the way it once did, with infielders standing where they should. Yet batting averages remain at historical lows. *PAGE D1*

A New Great Rivalry Rises
The Spurs beat the reigning champion Thunder to go to the N.B.A. finals this time, but this matchup is poised to become one for the ages. Think Celtics-Lakers or Pistons-Bulls. *PAGE D3*

OPINION A18-19
Andrew Weissmann *PAGE A18*



ARTS C1-6
Not So Forlorn Any More
Olivia Rodrigo’s first albums offered a fury about love gone wrong. Now, on the other side of her first “big-girl relationship,” her tone has changed. *PAGE C1*

